TEKS 110.36(4)(G) · ENGLISH II · COMPREHENSION

The Detail Sorter

Evaluate details to determine key ideas

NAME _____ DATE _____ PER. _____

Directions: Read the passage once and write your key idea in Step 1. Then re-read, sorting every detail you notice into one of the three columns. Finish with Step 3.

Where the Shade Goes

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · 189 WORDS

1 Every summer, Bellmont's east side runs hotter than its west side. On an August afternoon, thermometers on East Ninth Street have read twelve degrees higher than thermometers three miles away in the Highland district. Both neighborhoods sit at the same elevation. Both were built in the 1920s.

2 The gap is made of shade. Highland's streets are lined with mature oaks and sycamores whose canopies close overhead by mid-June. East Ninth lost most of its street trees to a road-widening project in 1978 and never replanted. Asphalt and rooftops absorb sunlight all day and release it slowly at night, so the east side cools hours later than the west. Residents there run air conditioners longer and pay more to do it, and emergency calls for heat illness cluster on the same blocks.

3 The city's arborist, Dana Ruiz, has planted 4,411 trees since 2016, most of them in the east side's empty planting strips. Ruiz grew up in Highland and studied forestry in Oregon. She says a young tree needs seven years of watering before it throws usable shade, which means the neighborhood is paying now for relief it will not feel until the next decade.

STEP 1 **After one read, the key idea of this passage is…** (one sentence, in pen)

STEP 2 **Re-read and sort every detail. Note the paragraph number for each.**

Key Idea Details States or carries the main point	**Supporting Details** Proves, explains, or measures it	**Irrelevant Details** True, but does not serve the point
¶ ____	¶ ____	¶ ____
¶ ____	¶ ____	¶ ____
¶ ____	¶ ____	¶ ____
¶ ____	¶ ____	¶ ____

STEP 3 **Write one sentence naming what column 1 proves.**

Did your Step 1 answer change after the second read? ☐ Yes — what changed it? ☐ No — what confirmed it?